

AWS

CERTIFIED CLOUD PRACTITIONER

CRAM SHEET

This Cram Sheet is your essential companion for AWS Cloud Practitioner exam preparation, designed to provide you with a clear roadmap to exam success.



online
learning.

EXAM BASICS

65 QUESTIONS

(50 scored,
15 unscored)

90 MINUTES

Passing score
= 700/1000

QUESTION TYPES

Multiple choice,
Multiple response

COST

\$100 USD

NOTE:

There is no penalty for guessing,
so never leave any questions blank.

The AWS Cloud Practitioner exam is organised into four weighted domains, each testing specific knowledge areas.

Understanding these weightings will help you allocate your study time by focusing more on higher weighted sections while ensuring you've covered all the fundamentals.

Below is a breakdown of each domain with the key concepts you need to master.

01

CLOUD CONCEPTS (24%)

- **Cloud benefits:** Scalability, Elasticity, Agility, High Availability, Global Reach, Pay-as-you-go.
- **Well-Architected Framework:** 6 pillars = Operational Excellence, Security, Reliability, Performance Efficiency, Cost Optimization, Sustainability.
- **Economics:** CapEx → OpEx, Rightsizing, Reserved/Savings Plans, TCO Calculator.

02

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE (30%)

- **Shared Responsibility Model:**
 - AWS = security of the cloud (facilities, hardware, hypervisor)
 - Customer = security in the cloud (data, IAM, configs).
- **IAM:** Users, Groups, Roles, Policies → **least privilege**.
- **Security Tools:** GuardDuty (threat detection), Shield (DDoS), WAF (web firewall), Inspector (vulns), Macie (sensitive data), Security Hub (central view).
- **Encryption:** At rest (KMS, SSE-S3), In transit (TLS/SSL).
- **Compliance:** Artifact = reports, Config = track changes, CloudTrail = logs, CloudWatch = monitoring.



EXAM TIP

SG = stateful, NACL = stateless

TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES (34%)

Compute:

- EC2 = servers, AMIs = recipes
- Auto Scaling = elastic capacity
- ELB = distributes traffic
- Lambda = serverless (pay per request)
- ECS/EKS = containers

Storage:

- S3 = object storage, 11 nines durability, storage classes (Standard, IA, Glacier)
- EBS = block storage (per EC2)
- EFS = network file system (multi-AZ)
- FSx = specialized file systems

Databases:

- RDS/Aurora = relational
- DynamoDB = NoSQL
- ElastiCache = in-memory cache
- Neptune = graph
- DMS = migrate DBs

Networking:

- VPC = private network
- IGW = internet gateway
- NAT = outbound only for private subnets
- Route 53 = DNS + routing policies (Simple, Weighted, Latency, Failover, Geo)
- CloudFront = CDN (edge caching)
- VPN / Direct Connect = secure/private links

AI/ML Services:

- SageMaker = build/train/deploy ML models
- Personalize = real-time product recommendations
- Comprehend = NLP, sentiment analysis, entity recognition
- Polly = text-to-speech
- Lex = chatbots/voice
- Rekognition = image/video analysis
- Translate = language translation
- Transcribe = speech-to-text
- Textract = extract text from scanned docs
- Kendra = intelligent search

BILLING, PRICING & SUPPORT (12%)

Pricing Models:

- On-Demand = hotel night (flexible)
- Reserved/Savings Plans = lease (1–3 yrs, up to 72% savings)
- Spot = last-minute ticket (90% discount, can be interrupted)
- Dedicated Host = own the house (compliance/licensing)

Cost Tools:

- Pricing Calculator = forecast
- Budgets = alerts (like spending caps)
- Cost Explorer = analyse trends
- CUR = detailed receipts
- Anomaly Detection = unusual spend alerts
- Service Quotas = resource limits (request increases if needed)

Support Plans:

- Basic = docs/forums
- Developer = email, <24h response
- Business = 24/7 phone/chat + full Trusted Advisor
- Enterprise/On-Ramp = TAM + concierge, fastest response times

Common Service Limits (Default):

- VPCs per Region → 5 (can request increase)
- Route Table Entries per VPC → 50
- EC2 Instances per Region → 20 (varies by type, can request increase)
- IAM Groups per Account → 300
- S3 Buckets per Account → 100



These are soft limits!
AWS allows you to request increases.



Now that you know what to study,
let's focus on how to tackle the exam itself.

EXAM STRATEGY

- **READ CAREFULLY:** watch for keywords
(most cost-effective, highly available, best practice)
- **ELIMINATE WRONG ANSWERS FIRST**
- **MANAGE TIME:** ~1.4 min per question
- **USE LOGIC:** match service to its “primary job”
(e.g. S3 = object storage, Lambda = serverless, RDS = relational DB)
- **STAY CALM:** there’s no negative marking

High-Frequency Exam Tips

- **IAM ROOT USER:**
Never use for daily operations; always enable MFA.
- **CLOUDTRAIL:**
Records API activity; CloudWatch monitors performance metrics.
- **SECURITY GROUPS:**
Are stateful; NACLs are stateless
- **MULTI-AZ:**
Deployments ensure high availability; Multi-Region supports disaster recovery.
- **S3 DURABILITY:**
Provides 11 nines (99.999999999%)
- **PRICING:**
Inbound data transfers are free; outbound transfers incur charges.

FINAL ADVICE:

If two answers look correct, pick the one closest to AWS best practices (secure, scalable, cost-effective).